Owen Skippen

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Education

British Columbia Institute of Technology (BCIT) Vancouver, BC
Diploma in Computer Systems Technology *September 2026 – Present*

- Expected Graduation: April 2028

Leadership & Experience

Server March 2024 – Present
Pho Ten *Richmond, BC*

- Provided excellent customer service by anticipating needs and responding promptly to requests
- Greeted and accommodated guests, building positive experience from first interaction
- Prioritized multiple tasks in dynamic environment and stayed calm and composed
- Checked in with guests throughout meal service, replenishing drinks and catering to additional requests
- Cleaned and sanitized hands and surfaces to maintain food safety and meet health department regulations

Projects

Verdant - SystemsHacks 2026 Winner | *React, Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Mapbox, NASA API*

- Won 1st place in the Systems for Scale track at SystemsHacks 2026 by developing a climate resilience dashboard for city agencies and environmental planners
- Built interactive web platform analyzing real-time satellite and sensor data from NASA APIs to map urban heat islands and identify optimal locations for green infrastructure
- Implemented OpenStreetMap and Mapbox visualizations with 3D mapping to translate complex climate data into accessible visual maps for city planners
- Designed AI-powered temperature reduction projections grounded in environmental science to help officials plan cooling interventions before construction
- Collaborated with a team of 4 to optimize data pipeline for large geospatial datasets in real-time while maintaining fast, responsive dashboard performance

Nullspace - StormHacks 2026 | *React, TypeScript, Three.js, Vite, Zustand, Tailwind CSS, Bun, Figma*

- Developed a 3D browser experience for the StormHacks 2026 Huawei Beyond Euclid challenge, letting players explore non-Euclidean geometry and impossible spaces in a dream-like world
- Built portal-based room transitions in Three.js that update the camera, player size, gravity, held objects, and lighting as players cross between connected spaces
- Rendered a curved spherical world with custom planet shaders, mapping structures and items onto the sphere so they keep their shape anywhere on the planet
- Implemented a carryable, throwable point-light lamp whose light passes through portal openings and scales with resizing doors
- Created a scroll-driven landing page from Figma designs with watercolour timelapse animations, layered sound, and a seamless transition into gameplay
- Collaborated with a team of 4 over 94 commits, managing game state with Zustand and validating changes with Bun test, lint, and build scripts before deploying to Vercel

Technical Skills

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Java, Python, HTML, CSS
Frameworks/Libraries: React, Next.js, Node.js, Express.js, Three.js, Zustand, Tailwind CSS, Mapbox GL
Developer Tools: Git, GitHub, VS Code, Vite, Bun, Vercel, Figma, Cursor, GitHub Copilot